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Reimbursement Policy

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1. Outline

An essential component of a well-structured organization, an Employee Reimbursement Policy is a carefully crafted framework that delineates the guidelines and procedures for employees to request reimbursement for expenses incurred while representing the company. This policy aims to strike a balance between providing fair and efficient reimbursement for legitimate business-related expenses and ensuring proper control and accountability over the entire reimbursement process. By maintaining adherence to this policy, the company can foster a culture of trust, transparency, and fiscal responsibility.

2. Eligible Expenses:

2.1 Meals & Entertainment

Purpose: This policy aims to provide guidelines for employees who are required to work beyond regular working hours on weekdays (beyond 9:00 p.m.) or Saturday and Sunday (depends on the roster) or public holidays at the office. In such cases, eligible employees may claim reimbursement for meal expenses incurred during these extended work hours, subject to specific conditions and approval by the functional head.

Eligibility Criteria: Employees eligible for meal expense reimbursement under this policy are those who fulfil the following conditions:

- a) The employee is required to work beyond the regular working hours on weekdays (beyond 9:00 p.m.) or is scheduled to work on Saturday and Sunday (depending on the roster) or public holidays at the office.
- b) There must be a legitimate business requirement for the extended work hours, which should be duly approved by the Function Head.

Reimbursement Limit: Under this policy, eligible employees are entitled to claim reimbursement of up to Rs. 250 (Indian Rupees) for meal expenses incurred during the specified late work hours on weekdays or work on weekends or public holidays.

Reimbursement Procedure:

- a) **Meal Expense Submission:** To avail the reimbursement benefit, eligible employees must submit original bills for meal expenses incurred during the extended work hours. The bills should be submitted to HRMS.
- b) **Exclusion of Alcohol Expenses:** Employees must ensure that the submitted bills do not include any expenses related to alcohol. Such expenses will not be eligible for reimbursement under this policy.

Excess Amounts: Any meal expenses exceeding the specified reimbursement limit of Rs. 250 will be borne by the employee, and the company will not reimburse the excess amount.

Approval and Disbursement: The L1 Manager and the finance team will review the submitted meal expense bills for compliance with the policy guidelines. Upon verification and approval, the eligible reimbursement amount will be processed and disbursed to the employee's designated account within the reimbursement cycles.

Policy Compliance and Review: All employees must adhere to this policy when claiming meal expense reimbursement for extended work hours.

Exceptions and Amendments: Any exception to this policy require the approval of the respective Function Heads. The company reserves the right to amend or update this policy as deemed necessary, with prior notice to all employees. In case, the expense is related to any customer expense, then it will require approval from the respective Practice Head.

2.2 Accommodation

For any kind of reimbursement related to the accommodation, employees can refer to the travel & reimbursement policy as per the path mentioned below

- Go to HRMS
- Click on HRIS
- Click on Policies/User Manuals/Useful Documents
- Click on Travel and Reimbursement policy v1_FY 2025-26

2.3 Mileage

Purpose: This policy outlines the guidelines and procedures for employees who are travelling for local business purposes or attending client meetings and wish to seek reimbursement for expenses incurred during such travels. The policy aims to provide a fair and efficient process for eligible employees to claim reimbursements, subject to appropriate approvals.

Eligibility: This reimbursement policy applies to employees who undertake local business travel or attend client meetings and utilize their transport. However, eligibility for reimbursement is subject to the following conditions:

- a) The employee must obtain prior approval from the respective Practice Head before commencing the travel.
- b) The employee must seek approval from the Practice Head after completing the travel to be eligible for reimbursement.
- c) This policy applies to client-facing teams with a grade level of G7 and above.
- d) If any employee is traveling by cab, metro, or bus, reimbursement will be done on the actuals, even if it is reimbursed by the client.

Mode of Travel	Cost per KM
Car	11
Bike	5

2.4 Mobile

The policy states no general provision/not by default for mobile bill reimbursement within the organization. However, in specific roles within the Operations team, mobile bill reimbursement may be considered on a case-by-case basis, subject to meeting role requirements and obtaining prior approval from both the Practice Head and Function Head.

The permissible reimbursement limits shall adhere to the guidelines outlined below. Reimbursement requests will be processed only upon the submission of valid postpaid mobile bill receipts, which must be in the name of the employee seeking reimbursement.

Guidelines for Mobile Bill Reimbursement:

Eligibility: The mobile bill reimbursement provision applies only to employees whose base location is India, designated roles across all the functions and is identified and approved by the relevant L1 Manager.

Work Level	Grade	Amount (INR)/month	Domestic Limit	International Limit
WL1 & WL2	G1 to G7	80% of the Total Bill	Maximum INR 400	Maximum INR 800
WL3	G8 And G9	80% of the Total Bill	Maximum INR 1200	Maximum INR 3000
WL 4 & above	G10A and above	On actuals	Maximum INR 2000	Maximum INR 5000

****Subject to the supporting bill submitted by the employee**

Prior Approval: Employees seeking mobile bill reimbursement must obtain prior approval from their respective L1 Managers before submitting reimbursement requests.

Reimbursement Limits: The permissible reimbursement limits for mobile bills are mentioned in the below table.

Validity: Reimbursement requests will only be considered for postpaid mobile connections.

Submission Requirements: Employees must submit their original, itemized postpaid mobile bills on HRMS. Bills should display the employee's name and the billing period.

Reimbursement Processing: Once the reimbursement request is received along with the necessary documents, the Finance department will review and process the request as per the payment cycle.

*All WL1 mobile reimbursements need to be approved by the respective L1 and L2 managers.

****No reimbursement shall be provided for internet and broadband connections.**

Overseas Employees

Employees whose base location is outside of India are eligible to claim mobile and internet expenses according to the following table:

Work level	Grade	Amount (AED)/month*	International Limit
WL1 & WL 2	G1 to G7	80% of the Total Bill	Maximum AED 800
WL3 & above	G8 and above	80% of the Total Bill	Maximum AED 2000

*equivalent currency in other countries.

3. Documentation:

Reimbursement Documentation: Employees must submit their reimbursement claims with appropriate supporting documentation to validate the expenses incurred. Acceptable documentation may include but is not limited to, receipts, invoices, boarding passes, expense reports, or any other relevant proof of expenses.

Timelines for Reimbursement Claims: All employees are required to submit their reimbursement claims promptly, adhering to the specific timelines which is within one month of the following quarter. Failure to comply with the specified timelines may result in delays while processing the reimbursement request.

Responsibility:

- **Employees:** It is the responsibility of each employee to accurately and comprehensively prepare their reimbursement claims and ensure that all necessary documentation is provided.
- **Manager:** The Approver must verify the accuracy and appropriateness of the reimbursement

claims before approving them for submission to the finance department.

- **Finance Department:** The Finance department is responsible for overseeing the reimbursement claim process and assessing the validity of the expenses submitted. They will process the reimbursement requests as per the payment cycle post-validation. **Non-Compliance:** Non-compliance with this policy may lead to delays in processing reimbursement claims or rejection of claims altogether. In case any bill is found incorrect, it may result in appropriate disciplinary action.

4. Submission Process

Reimbursement Submission Procedure: All reimbursement requests by employees must be submitted exclusively through the HRMS. This centralised platform streamlines the reimbursement process and ensures efficient handling by the finance department. Employees are required to adhere strictly to the designated deadline for reimbursement submission, as communicated by the finance department. Late submissions may lead to delays in processing or the potential rejection of claims.

Inquiry and Assistance: In the event of any queries or concerns regarding submitted reimbursements, employees are encouraged to seek clarification by reaching out to the finance department via email at finance.ap@peoplestrong.com.

5. Approval Procedures

Every reimbursement request shall be subject to the limits outlined in the policy guidelines. The reimbursement approval process shall adhere to the prescribed approval requirements corresponding to the employee's grade and the specific reimbursement category.

In the event of reimbursement denial, the employee can resubmit the request with additional supporting documents or address the remarks provided by the approver during the initial submission. Such resubmission shall follow the policies and procedures set forth by the company.

6. Client-facing team reimbursement

Following company guidelines, employees in client-facing roles from grade 7 and above are eligible to claim a reimbursement of up to Rs. 2000 for business-related dinners or lunches conducted with clients. To initiate the reimbursement process, employees must submit the necessary bills to the finance team through HRMS. It is important to note that any expenses related to alcohol shall not be included in the bill, as such claims will not be eligible for reimbursement.

Additionally, before taking clients out for lunch or dinner, employees must obtain approval from their respective Function Heads. This procedure ensures proper communication and adherence to company policies when engaging in client-related dining activities.

By adhering to this policy, we aim to facilitate appropriate expense management while fostering positive client relationships, which are vital to the success of our organization.

7. Currency and Exchange Rates

In the event that an employee is required to travel abroad for business purposes outside of India, they will be entitled to avail currency in the form of a per diem allowance which will be taxable, and the limit is mentioned in the detailed policy mentioned on HRMS. To facilitate this, the Lifeline team will issue a Forex card to the employee. This policy aims to ensure that our employees have access to the necessary funds while traveling internationally for business, thereby enhancing their ability to represent the company effectively and comfortably in global settings.

8. Timelines for Reimbursement

All reimbursements will be credited under the established finance payout frequency, scheduled on the 1st and 3rd Friday of each month. It is essential to note that any alterations to this payout schedule

will be communicated in advance by the finance department. Should any inquiries or concerns arise, please address them by contacting finance.ap@peoplestrong.com

9. Corporate Credit Card Eligibility

Eligibility Criteria:

Employee Grade: Corporate credit cards are available to employees at Grade 11 and above within the organization.

Role: Eligibility for a corporate credit card is determined by the employee's role within the organization.

Approval from L1 Manager: To obtain a corporate credit card, eligible employees must seek approval from their immediate L1 manager. The L1 manager will assess the employee's job responsibilities and business needs to determine whether a corporate credit card is warranted.

10. Non-Reimbursable Expenses

Following company guidelines, any expenses incurred by an employee for personal use or family-related purposes, as well as expenses that contravene the established company policy or lack properly authorized approval, shall not be eligible for reimbursement or consideration. All employees must adhere to the prescribed expense approval procedures and utilize company resources solely for business-related activities to maintain financial integrity and uphold the principles of responsible expenditure within the organization.

11. Consequences of Policy Violations

In adherence to the company's financial governance framework, any bill submitted by an employee shall be subject to thorough scrutiny for accuracy and compliance. If a submitted bill is deemed faulty or fails to meet the established criteria, appropriate action will be taken against the employee following company policies and procedures.

Furthermore, if payment for the disputed bill has already been processed, the employee shall assume full responsibility for rectifying the situation. It is incumbent upon the employee to promptly reimburse the entire amount back to the company, as per the terms and conditions specified in the reimbursement policy.

This policy is to ensure transparency, accountability, and responsible financial practices within the organization. By upholding these principles, we aim to maintain the integrity of our financial operations and safeguard the company's resources. All employees are expected to adhere to these guidelines and take the necessary precautions to avoid erroneous bill submissions, fostering a culture of fiscal prudence and reliability.

12. Conclusion

In conclusion, our organization firmly believes that the implementation of our comprehensive reimbursement policy will yield significant advantages for our esteemed employees. This policy is strategically designed to offer substantial financial support and foster a constructive work environment. The wide array of reimbursement options we provide is intended to alleviate the potential financial strain that may arise when employees undertake their job duties or seek avenues for professional development.

By adhering to these well-defined guidelines, we are committed to achieving and sustaining a harmonious work-life balance while simultaneously addressing the exigencies of business operations proficiently. We are confident that this policy will not only empower our workforce but also enhance overall productivity and foster a culture of continuous growth and development.